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Going Through Social Red Lights:

Combatting Hate Speech,
Prejudice, & Incitement

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Going Through Social Red Lights:

Combatting Hate Speech, Prejudice, and Incitement

“Ultimately, hate speech is rooted in prejudice and a lack of appreciation of diversity, cultural differences and diverging opinions. Those attitudes and stances are learned and can be unlearned.” (UNESCO, 2023)

ARTICLE BY: DR AWNI ETAYWE

IMAGE: © rawpixel.com



Language is fundamental to identity, both individually and culturally. All too often, language is used as the shorthand for defining cultural commonality and difference – and when tensions flare up, language is the first tool of violence. It, therefore, holds immense and transformative power, capable of both building and fracturing communities. And in the urgent fight against hate speech and prejudice, prioritising genuine human rights concerns and employing rigorous linguistic analysis are paramount.

Language not only mirrors reality but actively shapes it, moulding our experiences and converting perceptions into

meanings. Selective linguistic choices perpetuate sexual difference, racial otherness, and social inequalities.¹ Individuals utilise language and other semiotic tools to express hatred and provoke hostility, posing significant societal challenges.

By understanding these at a socio-linguistic level, we can illuminate the pivotal role of language in fomenting violence, providing insights into offenders' motivations and involvement in incitement.

Against a backdrop of declining global peacefulness, we are seeing prevalent issues of hate speech and aggression in contemporary discourse. Of significance, the U.S. National Consortium for the Study of Terrorism

and Responses to Terrorism (START) underscores the interlinkages between hate crimes and terrorism, noting that escalation in one often corresponds with an increase in the other, particularly in contexts of far-right extremism observed worldwide.

At the national Australian level, similar issues command attention, highlighting the critical need for effective strategies to combat hate speech and promote social cohesion. Continued online and offline hate crimes emphasise that victims of this deliberate harm remain underserved and are thus victims of an ongoing process of harm. Integral to tackling hate speech is de-conflating strategic political rhetoric.

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IMAGE: © Fibonacci Blue-Flickr

De-conflating strategic political rhetoric

It is not surprising that hate incidents often spike during events such as political votes, terror attacks, and genocidal policies. This was evident after the 9/11 attacks and during the spate of race-, religion-, sexual orientation-, disability-, and transgender-aggravated offences in England and Wales in 2017/2018 that resulted in a record 94,098 reported hate crimes, many of which can be linked to extremism and terrorism.

In Australia, the Albanese government has been working on a hate speech bill. Yet with the ongoing ('plausible' case of) genocide in Gaza (as per the ICJ), as well as the upcoming federal elections, the bill has been expected to encounter significant challenges and is facing a cul-de-sac in Parliament.

Australia is currently experiencing its own uptick in hate speech and violence, making these efforts to codify hate speech laws both timely and urgent, while also politically more trying and

controversial.

Many initially saw the bill as a test of Australia's ability to protect people from diverse backgrounds equally. However, the geopolitical context had led to the politicisation of the debate, setting back the legislation before it even reached Parliament. To understand this climate, we must recall the conflicting narratives from both major parties – some pushing for an increased focus on 'antisemitism', while others argued for

equal attention to all social groups. The Coalition, in particular, has called for prioritising antisemitism over the rights of other minorities. What lessons can we draw from this political tension to ensure the protection of all Australians moving forward?

There are several dangerous confluences at play here: 1. that any critique of Israel's illegal actions is 'antisemitic'; and 2. that Jewish identity is conflated with Zionism and Israel's actions.²

Australia is currently experiencing its own uptick in hate speech and violence, making these efforts to codify hate speech laws both timely and urgent



IMAGE: © Jon Tyson-Unsplash



IMAGE: © Ian Panelo-Pexels

These have been a simple and effective rhetorical bludgeon for many in parliament and the media to reach for since October 7th. Yet in eschewing nuance and diversity amongst both Jewish people and Muslims, this lays the groundwork for making hate crimes easier, not harder.

One needs only look at this conflation and its risks in context. On 31 May 2024, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu framed Israel's aggression on Gaza and constructed a binary opposition by using group membership and conflating Judaism with Zionism and political leadership: "Our victory is the victory of Israel against antisemitism. It is the victory of Judeo-Christian civilisation against barbarism."

This labelling of 'barbarism' is common in extremely hateful communication, such as the Christchurch shooter's manifesto 'The Great Replacement', where Muslim immigrants are portrayed as 'barbarians'.

The Albanese government's refusal to recognise Palestine as a state – despite

apparently supporting a two-state solution and already recognising Israel as a state – positions the government in alignment with Netanyahu's pledge to prevent the establishment of a Palestinian state, eliminate Gaza's civilian infrastructure, and expand illegal settlements in the West Bank and Jerusalem.

Likewise, international resistance to implementing any legal action against Israel's violations of international law, the 'plausible' case of genocide (ICJ), the use of starvation as a method of war leading to famine across Gaza, and other crimes against humanity (as per the ICC and the U.N. Human Rights Council) seem to support Israel's exceptionalism over the Palestinian population.

**ESCHEWING NUANCE AND DIVERSITY
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Multiculturalism and diversity come with obligations, as Senator Fatima Payman pointed out in the wake of her resignation from the Labour Party. The obligation is that all should have an equal place at the national table. As stressed by the Jewish Council of Australia, "Jewish safety in Australia and elsewhere is not at odds with Palestinian freedom." This disconnect between Australia's position on Palestine and our proclaimed sense of equality is putting social cohesion in our country under strain, and incidents of hate speech are mounting as noted in a recent ABC article.³

To effectively counter hate speech, both our laws and our society have to start by de-conflating group identities with the performance of political entities or fringe groups. Conflation and stereotyping are political and mental shortcuts that reduce the gap between individuals' initial fear/distress and their subsequent reactions. By appreciating diversity and resisting the urge to paint groups with the same broad brush, we increase the gap between what we experience and

Multiculturalism and diversity come with obligations, as Senator Fatima Payman pointed out in the wake of her resignation from the Labour Party



David Rowe, Financial Review, 2 July 2024: Letters to the Editor: Senator Fatima Payman owes her place in the Senate to Labor (afr.com)

the likelihood of resorting to physical or linguistic violence.

What is hate speech?

Between the Albanese government's earlier promises to curb hate crimes and the recent refocus of its proposed hate speech bill, the legislation's impact appears to have been significantly watered down, leaving many victims of targeted hate under-protected. What was once viewed as a bold move against challenging odds now seems to have stalled even before reaching Parliament. Despite these setbacks, the urgent need to restore the bill's

original focus and protect under-served communities from hate speech and incitement to hatred and violence remains as critical as ever.

According to UNESCO, hate speech is "any kind of communication in speech, writing or behaviour that attacks or uses pejorative or discriminatory language with reference to a person or a group on the basis of who they are, in other words, based on their religion, ethnicity, nationality, race, colour, descent, gender or other identity factors." Hate speech includes, *inter alia*, stereotyping, stigmatisation, and derogatory language.

- **Stereotyping:** Wrongful

generalisations, such as labelling Albanians in former Yugoslavia as "terrorists."

- **Stigmatisation:** Associating negative traits with a group, like referring to Muslims with epithets in violent incident reports. For example in a news report about a violent incident, instead of objectively describing the facts, the reporter repeatedly use phrases like "radical Muslims" or "Islamic terrorism" when the suspects' religious affiliation is irrelevant to the crime. Such language unfairly associates all Muslims with violence or extremism, perpetuating harmful



Daily Mail, 8 June 2024: <https://www.dailymail.co.uk/news/article-13507689/Manningham-home-melbourne-defaced-islamophobic-graffiti.html>



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identity attacks against the entire community — similar to Trump's references to a "Muslim ban" and the establishment of "a commission on radical Islam."

- **Derogatory language:** Using slurs or offensive terms, such as anti-Semitic or anti-Muslim graffiti. These processes are also used in

[Dutton] employed the topos of threat, claiming that accepting Palestinian refugees would put "our national security at risk"

war propaganda that often identifies social groups by their membership or ritual repetition of religious metaphors. For example, Serbian media used religious metaphors during the Yugoslav conflicts, referring to Kosovo as "Serbia's Jerusalem" to justify aggression.

Hate speech is also exacerbated by the rise of populist nationalism and xenophobia in election campaign speeches. There is perceived legitimization of hateful rhetoric when politicians, religious leaders, and the mainstream media produce and circulate disinformation, propaganda, racist and xenophobic ideas, or conspiracy theories directed towards a particular group of people to garner support.

Hate speech can be expressed through different forms: oral, written, visual forms (including video memes, drawings, etc). For example, in a press release dated June

21, 2024, the Islamophobia Register Australia (IRA) reported threatening graffiti on a toilet stall door, in an academic institution, referencing the Christchurch Mosque gunman; the graffiti read: "I KILL MUSLIM SCUM."

Hate speech undermines social cohesion, impacting living and learning

environments. Hate speech can involve various linguistic and rhetorical strategies.

Some linguistic strategies used in hate speech

Hate speech can take various forms, including referential and predicational strategies. Referential strategies use derogatory terms to identify a person or group:

- such as 'nigger' and 'chinks' (racionyms used in racial slurs),
- 'gypsies' and 'Palestinian' (ethnonyms, where the latter has been recently used by Donald Trump as a slur to attack his political rivals),
- and 'Muslims' and 'Jews' (religionyms).

For instance, in Finland, hate speech data includes statements like "Let's throw Muslims out of Europe." Predicational strategies attribute negative traits to a group, such as "Jews are social parasites" or "Homosexuality is inhuman"^{4,5}.

Another strategy involves topoi, or argumentative strategies, to justify preferential treatment or exclusion. For example, the 'topos of culture' justifies violence against groups perceived as problematic, while the 'topos of threat' claims that an influx of immigrants will overwhelm the native population.

Such strategies frame groups negatively, reinforcing social divisions. This manifests in media which plays a pivotal



role in shaping public perception and reactions, with coverage of terrorist incidents often exacerbating social divisions.

This rhetoric is also evident in political debates and parliamentary sessions that can foment hate crimes, such as Peter Dutton's call to reject all refugees from the genocide-torn Gaza Strip. He employed the topos of threat, claiming that accepting Palestinian refugees would put "our national security at risk."

According to Sarah Schwartz, a Human Rights Lawyer and Executive Officer of the Jewish Council Australia, such rhetoric stokes fear and division, foments racism and xenophobia, and comes weeks after far-right extremists' riots against immigrants in the UK and after "neo-Nazis held an anti-immigration rally in Melbourne's CBD."

The Jewish Council Australia, through Schwartz, rightly argues that the Australian Government "should not be influenced by the Israel Lobby's false

Israel's Defence Minister, Yuav Gallant referred to Palestinians as "human animals,"...this dehumanisation lays the groundwork for genocidal actions by denying shared humanity

and racist depictions of Palestinians" and that Australia needs to demonstrate its commitment to "its obligations under International Law to protect the human rights of refugees." You can read more about the Jewish Council's condemnation of Peter Dutton and Dave Sharma on their website.⁶

Journalistic reports that emphasise victims' religious backgrounds can inadvertently foster a 'We' versus 'They' mentality, contributing to societal polarisation and undermining multicultural ideals and lacking compassion for people coming from particular group membership (see, for example, "No compassion for Muslims?"⁷). Compassion should be systemic and based on our shared humanity.⁸

Identity attacks are rhetorical tools for in-grouping and out-grouping,

often used in political contexts, genocidal rhetoric, defamation texts, and extremist discourse.⁹ These attacks are ideology-informed, devaluing members of out-groups based on their master identities (e.g., religion, ethnicity, nationality, race, gender).

In Australia, a mother supporting 'Free Palestine' was targeted with Islamophobic graffiti, including clauses like "GET OUT MUSLIM C***" and "DEATH TO PALESTINE".

In violent extremist discourse, dehumanising language is common. Boko Haram's Shekau likens targeted out-groups to 'sheep,' 'spiders,' 'dogs,' 'pigs,' and 'rats.' Similarly, Israel's Defence Minister, Yuav Gallant referred to Palestinians as "human animals," declaring: "I have ordered a complete siege on the Gaza Strip. There will be no



electricity, no food, no fuel, everything is closed... We are fighting human animals and we are acting accordingly." This dehumanisation lays the groundwork for genocidal actions by denying shared humanity.

Far-right extremists use identity attacks to rationalise hate, as seen in the Christchurch shooter's manifesto, which describes Muslim immigrants as "barbarians" and "non-white scum." His manifesto explicitly incites hatred as a 'populism bond': "There was neither sign nor show; When the Saxon began to hate; ... It was not taught by the state."

Understanding these linguistic strategies is crucial for countering hate speech. Language that divides "us" from "them" must be challenged to foster social cohesion. By recognising and deconstructing these harmful narratives and various strategies of incitement to hatred and violence, we can promote respect and understanding across different communities.

Incitement of hatred and violence: Some strategies

Attorney-General Mark Dreyfus has reiterated the government's commitment to promoting respect,

acceptance, and understanding across Australia. Criminal penalties will apply if hate speech is likely to lead to damage, violence, or fear (see *The Guardian*).¹⁰

Hate speech often dehumanises individuals, infringes on human rights, causes psychological distress, and precedes violence.

Hostile speech includes incitement: language designed to persuade, compel, provoke, or encourage action against the victim group, and is thus a punishable language crime. Incitement can lead to violent actions (e.g., terrorist acts, hate crimes, genocide) or non-violent actions.

Incitement to non-violent actions covers several areas:¹¹

1. **Incitement to hatred:** This involves urging group members to develop hostility towards the victim group. For instance, Rwandan pop singer Simon Bikindi's pre-genocide song "Njyewe nanga Abahutu" ("I hate the Hutu") encouraged extremist Hutus to contempt and take hostile stances towards moderate Hutus supporting Tutsis. This resonates with incitement against both Palestinians and Jews who support the legal action against the 'plausible' case of genocide in Gaza.
2. **Incitement to discrimination:** This

involves urging in-group members to mistreat the victim group in non-violent ways. An example is a Nazi pamphlet distributed to German teenagers, warning them not to mix or marry Jewish people to avoid race "defilement."

3. **Incitement to persecution:** This involves calling for systematic exclusion of the victim group from society and civil rights, as seen in the Hutus' "Ten Commandments of the Hutu" in 1990, urging Hutus to separate from Tutsis and restricting Tutsis from joining the military or marrying Hutu women.

In incitement to violence, examining speech functions is crucial. Language users can employ explicit resources like imperative and exhortative constructions as rhetorical strategies for inciting illegal behaviour.

For example, the clause "KILL SADIQ KHAN" found in the Christchurch and the Buffalo shooters' manifestos, is an incitement message based on Khan's ethnicity and religion, arguing that killing him would be a revival for 'Our' race. This style of command or directive utterance directly incites the audience to destroy a particular group (member), with the speaker holding authority over their audience.

The Christchurch shooter used metaphors to alienate immigrants by equating their threat to a "nest of vipers," arguing that such "vipers" must be burned to protect 'our children'

IMAGE: © Tobias Bjorkli-Pexels

Incitement to violence can be constructed at the text level, where opposing social groups are constructed in discourse, condemned groups are positioned as threats, and hostility and violence are legitimised as morally reasonable. This discursive structure often appears in political and violent political discourse, such as jihadist and far-right extremist discourse.¹²

Indirect incitement is also common. For example, the Christchurch shooter used metaphors to alienate immigrants by equating their threat to a “nest of vipers,” arguing that such “vipers” must be burned to protect ‘our children’:

“When you discover a nest of vipers in your yard, do you spare the adolescents? Do you allow them to grow freely, openly, to one day bite your child as they play in their own yard? No. You burn the nest and kill the vipers, no matter their age. The enemies of our children are being born in our lands right now, even as you read this. [...] LEAVE NO VIPERS NEST UNBURNT.”

The Christchurch shooter also alluded intertextually to texts inciting hatred and violence, for example referencing

Pope Urban II’s words during the First Crusade to incite against Muslim immigrants: “Christian people, ASK YOURSELF, WHAT WOULD POPE URBAN II DO?”

Similarly, Netanyahu’s address on 28 October 2023, alludes to religious texts to justify violence in Gaza: “You must remember what Amalek has done to



SPEAKERS OFTEN JUSTIFY THEIR VERBALLY AGGRESSIVE BEHAVIOUR BY INVOKING SIX META-VALUES THAT MORALISE THEIR ACTIONS AND ESTABLISH SOCIAL BONDS

you, says our Holy Bible. And we do remember.” The relevant Biblical passage states: “Now go, attack Amalek, and proscribe all that belongs to him. Spare no one, but kill alike men and women, infants and sucklings, oxen and sheep, camels and asses.”

Regardless of the strategies used in incitement, language itself can reveal evidence of hostility towards people of particular identity memberships and provide clues to the motivations behind incited hostility and violent actions.

What does language reveal about an offender: hostility, and motivations?

Linguistic analysis can provide crucial insights into the evaluative and identity-based nature of hate speech, indicating the underpinning moral system.

In ideologically driven communications, linguistic research into the morality of online incitement to hatred and violence shows that speakers often justify their verbally aggressive behaviour by invoking six

meta-values that moralise their actions and establish social bonds, while also framing discourse to align with their in-group.¹³

1. **Ingroup/Loyalty:** This meta-value emphasises group membership obligations, virtues of loyalty, self-sacrifice, and vigilance against betrayal, reinforcing the need for a cohesive coalition against out-groups.
2. **Authority/Respect:** It underscores social order, hierarchical relationships, and respect for tradition and legitimate authority, appealing to virtues of leadership and followership.



These values not only shape ideological stances but also dictate the treatment of out-groups, underscoring the complex interplay between moral frameworks and hostile behaviours

3. **Purity/Degradation:** Concerned with sanctity and distancing from contamination, this meta-value portrays the in-group as pure and opposes desecration by others.
4. **Harm/Care:** Focuses on protecting in-group members from harm and empathising with their suffering, advocating for care and defence of group interests, resources, and environment.
5. **Fairness/Reciprocity or Cheating:** Involves (in)equality and reciprocal treatment, promoting virtues of altruism and compassion, while

condemning perceived unfair treatment or exploitation of the in-group.

6. **Liberty/Oppression:** Addresses resentment toward restrictions on freedom imposed by others, reacting to perceived injustices and unfair actions.

These meta-values serve to motivate hostile discourse and also categorise into two taxonomies: relational meta-values (ingroup/loyalty, authority/respect, purity/degradation) and inter-group treatment meta-values (liberty/oppression, harm/care, fairness/

cheating). They operationalise moral justifications for aggressive verbal behaviour, influenced by extreme far-right ideologies, which labels diversity as antithetical to equality and promotes hierarchical treatment of racial out-groups as "races of low intellect, low agency, muddled masses."

These values not only shape ideological stances but also dictate the treatment of out-groups, underscoring the complex interplay between moral frameworks and hostile behaviours in societal discourse, including digital and conspiratorial discourse.

Internet abuse, conspiracy theories, power, and deviance: Social threats fuel hate crimes

One of the cornerstones of intolerance is the invocation of deviance

from long-established ethics and the moral orders of society. This is strategically employed to reinforce in-group identities and marginalise out-groups. It is intricately linked to contested (or perceived) power relations that are often informed and confirmed by conspiracy theories endorsed by popular figures on social media.

Our collective meaning-making processes then construct societal boundaries, attaching judgments to events, actions, and individuals to maintain or challenge these power dynamics.

We are all familiar with the recurring themes of resource threats, job competition, and demographic changes that are prevalent in extreme far-right discourse, epitomised by

ideologies like the 'Great Replacement' conspiracy theory, or Pauline Hanson's claims of Australia being in danger of "being swamped by Muslims".

This narrative, treated as reality by its proponents, influences public perception and policy. The normalisation of such discourse, supported by influential figures and amplified by social media platforms, demonstrates

The construction of group identities as collective threats fosters moral disengagement, legitimising harmful actions against perceived others

the urgent need for counter-narratives that debunk language that goes through social red lights, and promote diversity, inclusion, and respect for human rights.

For instance, Dutch far-rightist **Eva Vlaardingerbroek**

popularised fear of diversity and immigration in her speech at CPAC Hungary in April 2024, which garnered over 57 million views. She argued against respect for diversity, human

rights to free movement, and immigrants' rights, framing these as resulting in "Less white people. Less of you." This speech propagates conspiracy theories, linking immigrants with crimes and portraying whiteness, Europeaness, and Christianity as under threat, while depicting social problems and crimes as 'imported problems' to be fought against.



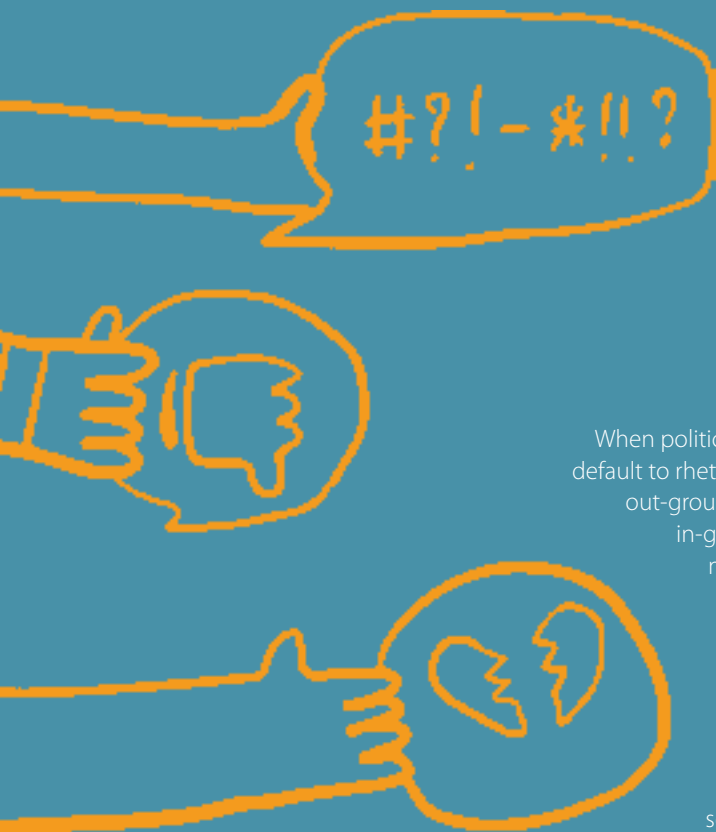
Involvement in the 'culture war' and 'race war' discourse by influential figures like **Elon Musk**

- whose question on 25 November

2022, "What do you think of the culture war?" received over 200k likes, 21k reposts, and over 96k comments - highlights the significant role of social media in shaping and normalising divisive rhetoric. One respondent suggested, "the Right needs to start funding more artists, filmmakers, and writers... We've been reacting too long. Time to go on the offensive."

The construction of group identities as collective threats fosters moral disengagement, legitimising harmful actions against perceived others. Addressing this issue requires effective measures to combat misleading news and manipulative discourse, both online and offline, aimed at reducing prejudice and promoting healthy social norms.

Scholarly works on moral disengagement and the morality of social (dis)affiliation and incitement underscore the importance of ethical standards in discourse and the need for interventions that mitigate the spread of hatred and violence based on group memberships.



When political and social leaders default to rhetoric that marginalises out-groups and reinforces in-group identities, they help mainstream and legitimise these corrosive linguistic systems, all in the name of political expediency

When political and social leaders default to rhetoric that marginalises out-groups and reinforces in-group identities, they help mainstream and legitimise these corrosive linguistic systems, all in the name of political expediency.

An understanding of the cumulative impact of such language on social cohesion and democratic values needs to be a focus of education and discussion if we are to counteract hate speech.

Conclusion and the path forward: Legality, legitimacy and measures to take

Prejudice lies at the heart of hate speech and incitement to violence.

Without fostering, learning, or upholding negative attitudes toward social groups, there would be no basis for hatred, discrimination, persecution, or violence. In today's world, characterised by declining global peacefulness, aggressive language and hate speech saturate the Internet, digital media discourse, and political communications, often targeting groups like "blacks," "Jews," "Muslims," "Asians," and more.

Despite its pivotal role in hate crimes,

the specific language used to incite hatred and violence remains inadequately discussed in public discourse. As a society, we need to sensitise both the public and decision-makers to the language that users must be held accountable for. Crucial to this effort are human rights-based legal frameworks and legitimacy values that support the effective counteraction of genuine hate speech.

Reflecting on the features of hate speech and the detrimental social effects of morally-deviant, hateful discourse, it becomes imperative to draw lessons from the consequences of such discourse. While morally-deviant behaviours can divisively shape interpersonal, inter-group, national, and global political landscapes, a Durkheimian perspective of deviance offers insight. That is, political deviance should serve as a reminder of the urgency of upholding our shared values. It should serve to reaffirm established moral orders, defining the moral boundaries that guide personal, cultural, legal, and institutional frameworks.

Challenging and confronting this deviance should unite people in reaffirming equality, restoring justice and condemning violence. It is these moral positions that can reinforce the alignment of social structures with individual and collective moral-agency. Establishing a clear legal and moral

compass based on shared human values is essential.

However, the pursuit of legal legitimacy in addressing hate speech should not imply the exclusion or preferential treatment of any group. Legality refers to adherence to established laws, while legitimacy transcends it, representing the justification of state power based on fundamental ethical principles of justice, equality, and recognition. Ideally, legality should be grounded in legitimacy.¹⁴

Australia's initiative to strengthen federal laws against hate speech, whether under the Albanese government or any future government, should align with this pursuit of legality and legitimacy. Upholding human rights laws and international agreements is crucial in maintaining a multicultural Australian society. This includes criminalising acts that propagate racial superiority, hatred, discrimination, and violence, as mandated by international treaties like the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights and the International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination.

Addressing hate speech in a robust legal framework is essential, particularly

in contexts where it intersects with incitements to genocide during times of conflict and unrest. Australia's multicultural ethos necessitates proactive measures that prevent division, extremism, antisemitism, and racism, fostering tolerance and respect for diversity. Effective strategies should actively engage credible voices and academic research, to ensure de-conflating strategic political rhetoric and nuanced

understanding and application of laws against hate speech.

Collaboration with international bodies like UNESCO can further strengthen Australia's educational responses to hate speech, enhancing digital citizenship skills, media literacy, and critical thinking among citizens.

Such initiatives are pivotal in countering extremist narratives, conspiracy theories, and disinformation campaigns online, thereby fostering appreciation of diversity and cultural differences, helping unlearn prejudice and safeguarding societal cohesion and human rights principles.¹⁵

**ESTABLISHING A CLEAR
LEGAL AND MORAL COMPASS
BASED ON SHARED HUMAN
VALUES IS ESSENTIAL**



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IMAGE: © Bahá'ís of the U.S - Flickr